

HTTP Methods

Backend development study note for document retrieval and grounded question-answering practice.

Common methods

GET retrieves a representation of a resource. POST submits data for processing and is often used to create a resource or trigger an operation. PUT replaces a resource representation. PATCH applies a partial modification. DELETE requests removal of a resource.

Choosing methods

Use methods according to their semantics and document their behavior in the API contract. For example, GET /products/42 retrieves product 42, while POST /products may create a product from a JSON request body.

Safe and idempotent methods

GET is defined as safe and idempotent. PUT and DELETE are idempotent by HTTP semantics, meaning repeated identical requests have the same intended effect as one request. POST is not generally idempotent.